

Buddhist prayer flags
From monastery doorways to village entrances, prayer flags can be seen fluttering everywhere in Bhutan.

Bhutan



Thimphu lies high in the Himalayas.



Smiling nation

Bhutan favors policies that focus on the happiness and well-being of its people. This country is called the happiest country in Asia.

Tiger's Nest Monastery

High up in the Paro Valley sits this 17th-century Buddhist temple, which marks the spot where Buddhism was first practiced in Bhutan.

0 50 km
0 50 miles
(approximate scale)

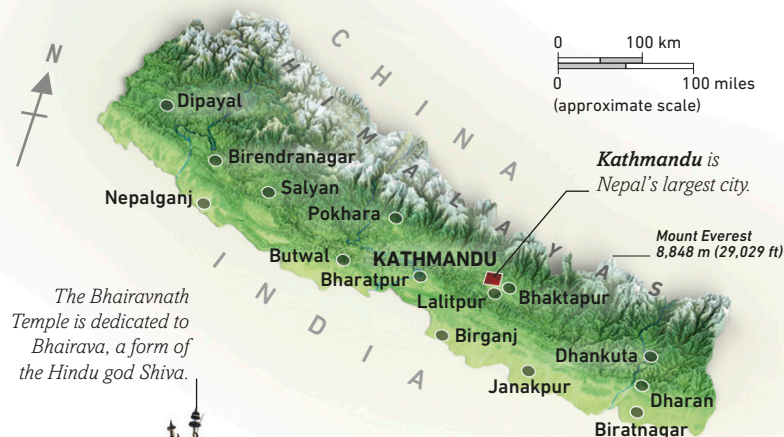


- 📏 14,824 sq miles (38,394 sq km)
- 👤 782,000
- ★ Thimphu
- 🗣️ Dzongkha, Nepali, Assamese

Bhutan is a small **Buddhist kingdom** in the eastern **Himalayas**. The country's **main export** is **hydropower**, generated by the **rivers** that flow down its **steep valleys**.



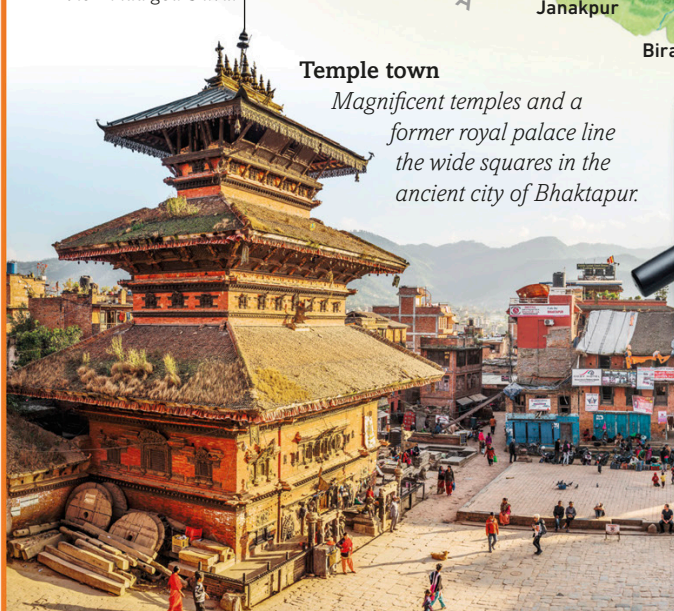
Nepal



The Bhairavnath Temple is dedicated to Bhairava, a form of the Hindu god Shiva.

Temple town

Magnificent temples and a former royal palace line the wide squares in the ancient city of Bhaktapur.



Top of the world

Mount Everest is the world's highest peak, located in southeastern Nepal. Many mountaineers climb its steep slopes, but fewer than 10,000 people have reached its summit.



- 📏 56,827 sq miles (147,181 sq km)
- 👤 30.3 million
- ★ Kathmandu
- 🗣️ Nepali, Maithili, Bhojpuri

Three-quarters of Nepal is covered in **mountains**, including many of the world's most **majestic peaks**. Its wildlife includes the **Asiatic elephant**, the **one-horned rhinoceros**, and the very rare **snow leopard**.